

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction
for the administration of Bexsero for vaccination against Meningococcal Group B

Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Meningitis B Vaccination

Overview

- **Meningococcal group B (MenB)** is a leading cause of **bacterial meningitis and septicaemia**, particularly in **infants and young children**.
- The **MenB vaccine (Bexsero®)** is a **protein-based vaccine** that protects against invasive **Neisseria meningitidis group B** disease.

Routine Childhood Immunisation

Schedule (UK NHS programme):

- **First dose:** at **8 weeks** of age
- **Second dose:** at **16 weeks**
- **Booster:** at **12–13 months** (toddler booster)

Included in the **routine UK childhood immunisation schedule** since **September 2015**.

High-Risk Groups

MenB vaccine is also recommended for:

- Individuals with **functional or anatomical asplenia**
- Those with **complement deficiencies** or on **complement inhibitor therapy** (e.g. eculizumab)
- Close contacts of a **confirmed MenB case**
- During **outbreak control** in specific settings

Catch-Up Vaccination

- Available for certain age groups or clinical risk groups on specialist advice.
 - No routine catch-up for children born before the introduction of the programme (pre-2015), unless in high-risk categories.
-

Administration

- **Intramuscular injection** into the anterolateral thigh (infants) or deltoid (older children/adults).
 - Can be co-administered with other childhood vaccines, but **increased risk of fever**.
-

Prophylactic Paracetamol

- Recommended for **infants under 1 year** receiving MenB vaccine, especially at **8 and 16 weeks**:
 - First dose **as soon as possible** after vaccination.
 - Two further doses at **4–6 hour intervals**.
 - Reduces risk of **post-vaccination fever**.
-

Contraindications

- Severe allergic reaction to a previous dose or a vaccine component.
 - Defer in the case of acute severe febrile illness (minor infections are not a reason to delay).
-

Side Effects

- Common: Fever (especially when given with other vaccines), injection site pain/swelling, irritability, loss of appetite.
- Rare: Hypersensitivity reactions.

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Bexsero

for vaccination against

Meningococcal Group B

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC ● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. ● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines ● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication ● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer ● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal ● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products ● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Bexsero is indicated for active immunisation against invasive disease caused by <i>Neisseria meningitidis</i> group B in individuals from 2 months of age and older, in accordance with the national immunisation programme or risk-based assessment.
Inclusion criteria	- Infants from 2 months of age and older, children, and adults at increased risk of meningococcal group B disease. - Eligible under national immunisation schedule or risk-based guidance. - Informed consent obtained. - No contraindications to vaccination.
Exclusion criteria	- Known hypersensitivity to the active substance or any excipients. - Previous severe allergic reaction to a meningococcal B vaccine. - Acute febrile illness (vaccination should be postponed until recovered).
Cautions	- Paracetamol may be recommended with infant doses to reduce risk of fever. - Observe for 15 minutes post-vaccination. - Administer in accordance with age-specific schedule and spacing intervals. - Inform recipient/guardian of common side effects and follow-up requirements.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Bexsero
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C). Do not freeze. Protect from light.
Route/method of administration	Intramuscular injection, usually in the anterolateral thigh (infants) or deltoid muscle (older children/adults).
Dose and frequency	Infants (from 2 months): 3-dose primary schedule at 2, 4, and 12 months. Catch-up or at-risk individuals: 2-dose primary schedule with a booster as advised.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	0.5 mL per dose.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	Follow national immunisation schedule or clinical guidance.
Adverse effects	Fever, irritability, tenderness at injection site, sleepiness, loss of appetite. Older individuals: headache, nausea, muscle pain. Rare: allergic

	reactions. Refer to SmPC.
--	---------------------------

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: ● that valid informed consent was given ● name of individual, address, date of birth and GP ● name of healthcare practitioner ● name and brand of medication ● date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied ● advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment ● details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: ● Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years ● Children aged under 18 years -keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with the medication.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	To seek medical advice if symptoms worsen rapidly or significantly, do not improve in 3–4 weeks, or they become systemically very unwell.

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines [BNF \(British National Formulary\) | NICE](#)
- Summary of Product Characteristics for drug

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the

responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates			
Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date		Expiry date	

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		25/08/2025
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		25/08/2025

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	25 th June 2025